

Generated from the competition table

1996 Men's Ballon d'Or

Everything the Men's Ballon d'Or table records about 1996, with the winner linked to their full award history and their national team linked to its own record.

Winner

Matthias Sammer

National team

Germany

Ceremony date

24 December 1996

All Men's Ballon d'Or editions →



References & review

Status: verified

Last reviewed: 3 September 2026

- Official winners and rankings (<https://ballondor.com/all-rankings>)
- Official homepage (<https://ballondor.com/>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.rsssf.org/miscellaneous/europa-poy65.html>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.britannica.com/topic/Ballon-dOr>)
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.jeuneafrique.com/381505/politique/jour-26-dece-mbre-1995-george-weah-elu-ballon-dor/>)
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.voanews.com/>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.uefa.com/uefachampionsleague/news/>).
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (<https://www.si.com/soccer/what-is-the-kopa-trophy-past-winners-nominees-2025>).

- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (<https://www.90min.com/what-is-kopa-trophy-past-winners-no-minees>),
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (<https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/kopa-trophy.htm>),
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (<https://www.sportsdunia.com/football-analysis/list-of-kopa-trophy-winners>),
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (<https://www.chaseyoursport.com/football/list-of-kopa-trophy-winners/8061>),
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (<https://www.givemesport.com/every-winner-kopa-trophy-ranked/>),
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kopa_Trophy),
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (<https://www.fcbarcelona.com/en/football/first-team/news/4367534/lamine-yamal-retains-kopa-trophy/featured>),
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (https://www.tntsports.co.uk/football/ballon-d-or/2025/lamine-yamal-retains-kopa-trophy-for-best-young-player-vicky-lopez-takes-inaugural-womens-prize_sto23224406/story.shtml),
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (<https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/yashin-trophy.htm>),
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (<https://www.premierleague.com/en/news/4420829/donnarumma-and-gyokeres-win-awards-at-2025-ballon-dor>),
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (<https://goaltheball.com/yashin-trophy-winners-list/>),
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (<https://www.fotmob.com/el/news/x3syvn394xhu179pkuk2k9k4y/ballon-d-or-2019-liverpool-goalkeeper-alisson-wins-inaugural-yachine-trophy>),
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (<https://www.goal.com/en-ca/lists/aston-villa-and-argentina-goalkeeper-emiliano-martinez-retains-yashin-trophy-as-world-s-best-goalkeeper-in-2024/blt47f77564722f26b5>),
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (https://fr.wikipedia.org/wiki/Troph%C3%A9e_Yachine),
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (<https://www.footmercato.net/a7278391082899020163-ballon-dor-2025-gianluigi-donnarumma-remporte-le-trophee-yachine>)

- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (<https://www.realmadrid.com/en-US/news/football/first-team/special-features/courtois-yashin-trophy-winner-2022>).
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (<https://www.tntsports.co.uk/football/ballon-d-or/2022/ballon-dor-2022-thibaut-courtois-wins-yashin-trophy-for-best-goalkeeper-after-real-madrid-heroics-la-sto9191911/story.shtml>).
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (<https://www.90min.com/posts/emiliano-martinez-wins-2023-yashin-trophy>).
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (<https://www.besoccer.com/new/emiliano-martinez-wins-back-to-back-yachine-trophy-awards-1335839>).
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (<https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/striker-of-the-year.htm>).
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (<https://www.90min.com/what-is-gerd-muller-trophy-past-winners-nominees>).
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (<https://www.gamereactor.eu/what-is-the-gerd-muller-trophy-and-who-will-win-this-year-at-ballon-dor-2025-1605433/>).
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (<https://www.arsenal.com/news/viktor-gyokeres-wins-gerd-muller-trophy>).
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (<https://fcbayern.com/en/news/2022/10/muller-trophy-for-year%E2%80%99s-best-striker-awarded-for-the-first-time-at-the-ballon-dor-ceremony>).
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gerd_M%C3%BCller_Trophy).
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (<https://www.bavarianfootballworks.com/2022/10/18/23409746/robert-lewandowski-striker-award-2022-gerd-muller-fc-barcelona-bayern-munich-alum-haaland-benzema>).
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (<https://www.fcbarcelona.com/en/news/2858120/lewandowski-wins-inaugural-gerd-muller-trophy/featured>).
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (<https://www.fourfourtwo.com/features/ballon-dor-what-is-the-gerd-muller-trophy>).
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (<https://sports.yahoo.com/article/won-gerd-muller-trophy-2025-201726350.html>).

- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) ([https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Johan_Cruyff_Trophy_\(France_Football\)\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Johan_Cruyff_Trophy_(France_Football)))),
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (<https://www.goal.com/en-us/lists/carlo-ancelotti-men-s-coach-of-year-ballon-d-or-ceremony-xabi-alonso-pep-guardiola/blt4f9630905d966f8d>),
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (<https://www.besoccer.com/new/real-madrid-boss-ancelotti-wins-men-s-johan-cruyff-trophy-1335838>)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (<https://www.beinsports.com/en-us/soccer/articles-video/ancelotti-is-the-best-coach-of-the-year-2024-10-28>)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (<https://www.managingmadrid.com/2024/10/28/24282158/carlo-ancelotti-wins-coach-of-the-year-award>)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (<https://sports.yahoo.com/article/psg-head-coach-luis-enrique-193800045.html>)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (<https://www.besoccer.com/new/luis-enrique-wins-2025-johan-cruyff-trophy-for-world-s-best-coach-1374497>)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (<https://www.caughtoffside.com/2025/09/22/ballon-dor-2025-luis-enrique-best-coach/>)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (<https://tribuna.com/en/news/2025-09-22-luis-enrique-wins-johan-cruyff-trophy-at-2025-ballon-dor/>),
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/S%C3%B3crates_Award),
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (<https://www.peace-sport.org/socrates-award/>)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (<https://www.peace-sport.org/news/the-senegalese-sadio-mane-becomes-the-first-winner-of-the-socrates-award-at-the-2022-ballon-dor-ceremony/>)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (<https://fcbayern.com/en/news/2022/10/sadio-mane-the-inaugural-winner-of-the-socrates-award>)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (<https://www.peace-sport.org/news/vinicius-junior-wins-socrates-award-at-the-2023-ballon-dor-ceremony/>)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (<https://www.besoccer.com/new/vinicius-wins-socrates-2023-award-for-his-humanitarian-work-1287586>)

- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (<https://www.90min.com/what-is-socrates-award-past-winners-nominees>).
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (<https://www.olympics.com/en/news/ballon-dor-2025-all-winners-all-awards-complete-list-live-updates>).
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (<https://www.peace-sport.org/news/h-s-h-prince-albert-ii-and-peace-and-sport-welcome-the-xana-foundation-winner-of-the-2025-socrates-award-in-monaco-2/>).
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (<https://www.monaco-tribune.com/en/2025/09/ballon-dor-2025-ceremony-princess-charlene-presents-socrates-prize-to-xana-foundation/>).
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (<https://www.gamereactor.eu/luis-enriques-xana-foundation-named-after-his-late-daughter-wins-socrates-award-for-humanitarian-work-1605953/>).

Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.